

Yiyang Lu

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EDUCATION

William & Mary

Ph.D. in Computer Science, co-Advisors: Prof. Jie Ren, Prof. Evgenia Smirni

Williamsburg, VA, USA

Sep 2021 — Present

University of Electronic Science and Technology of China

B.S. in Software Engineering

Chengdu, China

Sep 2016 — Sep 2020

Research Interests: Agentic AI, Resilience, Anomaly Detection, Safety-Critical Systems, Time Series Analytics, HPC

PUBLICATIONS

Yiyang Lu, Woong Shin, Ahmad Maroof Karimi, Feiyi Wang, Jie Ren, Evgenia Smirni. “Introspective and Interactive Visual Grounding for Visualization Agents.” ACM SIGMETRICS 2026 Student Poster Session, to be presented.

Yiyang Lu, Woong Shin, Ahmad Maroof Karimi, Feiyi Wang, Evgenia Smirni, Jie Ren. “ML-Based GPU Error Prediction in Production HPC: Challenges and Trade-offs.” (SUBMITTED)

Yiyang Lu, Jie Ren, Evgenia Smirni. “Mantis: Decoding HPC Telemetry Data for Robust System Prediction.” In Proceedings of the 40th ACM International Conference on Supercomputing (ICS 2026), to appear.

Daniel Rodriguez-Cardenas, David N. Palacio, Anna Schmedding, **Yiyang Lu**, Bill Hudson, Chris Gourley, Michael Roytman, Chris Shenefel, Evgenia Smirni, Denys Poshyvanyk. “On Predicting Vulnerability Severity Using In-Context Learning: An Industrial Case Study.” Journal of Software: Evolution and Process, to appear.

Anna Schmedding, Philip Schowitz, Xugui Zhou, **Yiyang Lu**, Lishan Yang, Homa Alemzadeh and Evgenia Smirni. “Strategic Resilience Evaluation of Neural Networks Within Autonomous Vehicle Software.” In Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Computer Safety, Reliability, and Security (SAFECOMP 2024), pp. 33–48, 2024.

Yiyang Lu, Jie Ren, Yasir Alanazi, Ahmed Mohammed, Diana McSpadden, Laura Hild, Mark Jones, Wesley Moore, Malachi Schram, Bryan Hess, Evgenia Smirni. “Investigating Anomalies in Compute Clusters: An Unsupervised Learning Approach.” In Proceedings of the International Conference for High Performance Computing, Networking, Storage, and Analysis (SC 2023 Research Posters), November 2023.

Bi, Shengjie, **Yiyang Lu**, Nicole Tobias, Ella Ryan, Travis Masterson, Sougata Sen, Ryan Halter, Jacob Sorber, Diane Gilbert-Diamond, and David Kotz. “Measuring Children’s Eating Behavior with a Wearable Device.” In 2020 IEEE International Conference on Healthcare Informatics (ICHI), 1–11. Oldenburg, Germany: IEEE, 2020.

EXPERIENCE

Oak Ridge National Laboratory (ORNL), Graduate Research Intern

HPC system operation, Agent

Oak Ridge, TN, USA

June 2025 - Aug 2025

William & Mary, Research Assistant

HPC system operation, Reliability, Autonomous Vehicle Safety, GPUs

Williamsburg, VA, USA

June 2022 - Present

William & Mary, Teaching Assistant

Discrete Structures, Network Systems and Design, Data Structures

Williamsburg, VA, USA

Sep 2021 - May 2022

ByteDance, Research & Development Intern

Network Traffic Analysis

Shenzhen, China

Dec 2020 - Jul 2021

Shenzhen Institute of Advanced Technology (SIAT), Research Assistant

Brain-Computer Interface and Neuromorphic Intelligence

Shenzhen, China

May 2020 - Oct 2020

Dartmouth College, Research Assistant

Auracle – wearable technology for the study of eating behavior

Hanover, NH, USA

Mar 2019 - Aug 2019

PROJECTS

Data Science Agent

June 2025 – Present, W&M

Coding agents are transforming Data Science but struggle with chart understanding: the Vision-Language Models (VLMs) they use often hallucinate values from the pixel data.

- Built visualization agents with direct plot introspection and interaction to alleviate VLM data hallucination.
- Developed iPlotBench, a benchmarking suite for evaluating agentic visualization capabilities.
- Formulated deterministic accuracy metrics to rigorously validate the semantic correctness of generated visualizations.
- Developed Deep Plot: Agents for iterative data exploration and automated insights generation.
- Implemented MLE, a MCTS-based ML solution searcher utilizing parallel workers on multiple git worktrees.

HPC Telemetry Analysis

May 2023 - Present, W&M

As compute clusters continue to grow in scale and complexity, the analysis of HPC telemetry becomes increasingly challenging. This project aims to leverage novel learning methods to understand system dynamics.

- Proposed a predictive framework that adapts to diverse tasks, including anomaly detection and workload prediction.
- Developed a method to reveal telemetry relationships, offering a holistic view of system behavior.

Resilience Evaluation of Autonomous Vehicle Models

May 2023 - May 2024, W&M

Deep neural networks (DNNs) have driven rapid improvements in autonomous vehicle technology. Given the safety-critical nature of these systems, rigorous fault detection is essential to prevent potential hazards and accidents.

- Performed strategic resilience evaluation on an L4 autonomous driving system.
- Examined the effectiveness of mitigation on critical faults in autonomous vehicles.

Network Traffic Analysis

Dec 2020 - Jul 2021, ByteDance

- Optimize the rules and policies for NTA (Network Traffic Analysis).

Brain-Computer Interface

May 2020 - Oct 2020, SIAT

- Set up the Neuronpixels electrodes and implement wired/Bluetooth communication on the MCUs.

Auracle

Mar 2019 - Aug 2019, Dartmouth

- Implement the energy-efficient algorithm for classification task on a wearable device.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

HPDC'26: International Symposium on High-Performance Parallel and Distributed Computing 2026 (subreviewer)

Sigmetrics'26: Special Interest Group on Measurement and Evaluation 2026 (subreviewer)

Sigmetrics'25: Special Interest Group on Measurement and Evaluation 2025 (subreviewer)

Sigmetrics'24: Special Interest Group on Measurement and Evaluation 2024 (subreviewer)

MSN 2022: The 18th International Conference on Mobility, Sensing and Networking (subreviewer)

SKILLS

- Programming Languages: Python, Embedded C, Java, Go
- Data analysis: PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, Pyspark, Tsfresh, Librosa, Optuna, Matplotlib, Plotly, PyG, Networkx
- Simulators: Carla, Apollo, Autoware
- Databases: Spark, Hive, Elasticsearch, ClickHouse